

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) | SIEM Deployment Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am an experienced Senior Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on expertise designing, implementing, and optimising Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) solutions within complex enterprise environments. I bring deep expertise in Kusto Query Language (KQL), analytics rule development, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, alongside strong CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and endpoint detection and response (EDR) capabilities. I have proven experience enabling managed detection and response (MDR) solutions at scale, building SOAR automation playbooks, and delivering security engineering projects from design through to production deployment. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) qualification and am a confident communicator, experienced presenting technical security findings to senior stakeholders and working effectively in remote, cross-functional teams.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel (SIEM):** Analytics rules, KQL query authoring, data connectors, workbooks, threat hunting, incident investigation - strong hands-on experience in enterprise deployments
- **Microsoft Defender XDR:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender - 8,000-user deployment
- **SOAR and Security Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks, Logic Apps integration, automated alert triage and incident response workflows, SOAR automation engineering
- **Kusto Query Language (KQL):** Advanced KQL for threat detection, detection-as-code, custom analytics, scheduled queries, hunting workbooks
- **CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR / NG-SIEM):** Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM, Spotlight - expert level administration and detection engineering
- **Azure and Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure, Entra ID (Azure Active Directory (Azure AD)), Conditional Access, cloud-native security architecture
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Threat Detection and Threat Hunting:** Detection engineering, MITRE ATT&CK-based threat modelling, proactive threat hunting, alert tuning and optimisation
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61 framework, MITRE ATT&CK framework, containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident reporting
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, Python fundamentals, infrastructure-as-code security principles
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- University of the Arts London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer** | Dec 2020 - Present
- University of the Arts London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer | Dec 2020 - Present
- Designed and implemented Microsoft Sentinel SIEM solution, configuring data connectors, KQL-based analytics rules, detection rules, scheduled queries, and threat-hunting workbooks to detect, investigate, and respond to security threats across the enterprise.
- Design and implement SOAR automation playbooks within Microsoft Sentinel using Logic Apps to automate alert triage, incident enrichment, and response workflows, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) and analyst workload.

- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, optimising detection coverage, tuning policies, and driving alert quality improvements across the XDR estate.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, EDR, NG-SIEM, Insight, Discover) across 8,000+ endpoints: configure detection rules, host group policies, prevention settings, and automated response workflows.
- Perform proactive threat hunting using Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, leveraging the MITRE ATT&CK framework to identify indicators of compromise (IOCs) and threat actor behaviours across network, identity, and endpoint telemetry.
- Develop and maintain detection-as-code: author, version, and optimise KQL analytics rules aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, reducing false positive rates and improving signal fidelity.
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) security posture: Conditional Access policies, Multi-factor Authentication (MFA) enforcement, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), and identity threat investigation via MDI.
- Lead vulnerability management using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), reporting risk to leadership and driving remediation with infrastructure teams.
- Act as the senior technical lead for security incident response, following the NIST SP 800-61 framework for containment, eradication, and post-incident analysis.
- Support compliance and audit activities aligned to ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, and NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF).

University of the Arts London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity
 Delivered Microsoft Sentinel SIEM operations: monitored alerts, investigated incidents, authored KQL queries for detection tuning, and managed data connectors across the Microsoft security stack. *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Administered and optimised Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across the enterprise: onboarded endpoints, managed detection policies, investigated endpoint alerts, and performed threat hunting.
- Supported CrowdStrike Falcon EDR administration: host group management, policy configuration, Falcon Spotlight vulnerability assessment, and detection response workflows.
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) including Conditional Access, MFA deployment, and identity lifecycle for an 8,000-user estate.
- Built and maintained PowerShell automation scripts to streamline security operations workflows and accelerate incident response activities.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning and remediation tracking using Tenable.io and Nessus; produced risk-prioritised reports for infrastructure and senior security teams.
- Managed Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies, ensuring device compliance across a large endpoint estate.
- Supported security incident response playbook development and post-incident reviews aligned to MITRE ATT&CK and NIST SP 800-61.

HCM Solutions Ltd (SaaS/Fintech) - IT Engineer, Security, Quality and Infrastructure
 Managed security operations and infrastructure in a cloud-native SaaS environment, implementing security controls aligned to ISO 27001 and SOC 2 requirements. *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Administered Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), MFA, SSO, and user access lifecycle management for a cloud-first technology estate.
- Monitored and investigated security events, managing alert triage and incident escalation processes for cloud and endpoint environments.
- Managed endpoint security tooling, patch management, and vulnerability remediation activities, reducing exposure across the endpoint estate.
- Supported development of security policies, procedures, and compliance reporting documentation.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Delivered a full-scale Microsoft Sentinel SIEM deployment at UAL, engineering data connectors, KQL analytics rules, and SOAR playbooks that automated triage for the majority of routine security alerts.
- Built a library of KQL detection rules aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, significantly improving threat detection coverage across identity, endpoint, and cloud workloads.
- Led enterprise CrowdStrike Falcon EDR deployment across 8,000+ endpoints, integrating with Microsoft Sentinel NG-SIEM for unified detection and response coverage.

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across the full M365 estate, enabling XDR visibility across endpoint, identity, and email attack surfaces.
- Designed and delivered SOAR automation playbooks that reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) to security incidents by automating alert enrichment, user notification, and initial containment steps.
- Established a structured vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), reducing critical vulnerability exposure and providing executive-level risk reporting.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Remote (UK)